

Seawall height in Palm Beach Gardens

The elevation your city requires, the datum it is measured in, and the section of code that says so.

PALM BEACH GARDENS • PALM BEACH COUNTY

No minimum set in local code

Palm Beach Gardens' code has no seawall section and sets no seawall height. Seawalls appear only in the floodplain rules and the fertilizer setback.

The detail

MINIMUM	None found in Code of Ordinances or LDR (Ch. 78)
FLOODPLAIN	In Zone V, bulkheads and seawalls are allowed only if also authorized by the proper federal, state or local agency, kept apart from buildings, and backed by a registered design professional's analysis of floodwater diversion and wave runup; no elevation is set - Sec. 86-137 (Ord. No. 15, 2017)
FERTILIZER	None within 10 ft of the top of a seawall or lake bulkhead, or 3 ft with a deflector shield or drop spreader - Sec. 34-39 (Ord. No. 20, 2011)
DOCKS	An individual private boat dock, for the exclusive use of the upland owners or residents, is an allowed residential accessory use, and boat docks are excused from the principal structure's setbacks - Sec. 78-181(4)d, (5)d

Where this comes from: City of Palm Beach Gardens Code of Ordinances (Municode), Ch. 86 Art. III Floodplain Management; Ch. 78 Land Development; Ch. 34 Sec. 34-39; Ch. 78 Sec. 78-181

Verified: 2026-10. Rules change — check the date above against today.

Before you call a contractor

1 Know your datum

A height means nothing without the datum it is measured from. NAVD88 and MLW are different reference points and the same wall gives different numbers in each. Ask which one any quoted elevation refers to.

2 Get the existing elevation surveyed

You cannot tell whether a wall meets the requirement by looking at it. A surveyor shooting the top of the cap settles it in an hour.

3

Ask what triggers the requirement

Most cities only apply the minimum to new walls or to substantial repair. What counts as substantial is defined differently in each city, and it is usually a percentage of length or of cost.

4

Ask about building higher now

Several cities require a wall built below the final figure to be engineered so it can be raised later. Doing it once is cheaper than doing it twice.